



## Has US exceptionalism returned already?

**Exceptionalism back in the frame.** We've argued [several times](#) in the past year that the US exceptionalism of 2023/24 has waned, not because of any big shift in the US but because the rest of the world has caught up. And this change removes a pillar of support for the dollar. But exceptionalism seems to be back in 2026, and has contributed to our [neutral](#) (though not bullish) dollar view.

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**There's plenty to like in the US.** Forecasts are for US GDP growth to be top-3 amongst G10 again after a lull last year, and for the US to exceed the peer average by ¾%pt ([Figure 1](#)). Consistent with that, US data surprises have been very positive in recent months, a stark contrast to the eurozone ([Figure 2](#)). Similarly, earnings revisions look far better in the US ([Figure 3](#)). And the Fed has been hawkishly repriced vs peers in the past month - the 2-year spread is up a chunky 40bps. Lastly, US equities have outperformed RoW by 7% over the past three months. The impact of the AI cycle is clearly evident. So a recipe for dollar strength? Not so fast - there are some challenges with easily translating all this into a bullish dollar view.

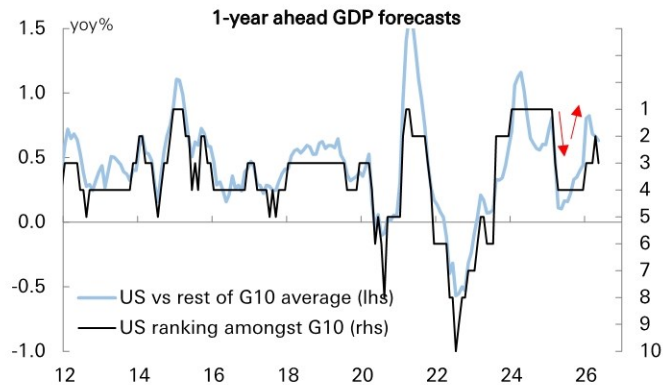
- **S&P not GDP.** While US equities have outperformed recently, they're still a laggard on a 6-month and 12-month basis. And the US may be a clear out-performer in economic terms, it's much less so when it comes to corporate earnings, and that should matter more for global equity investors. Rest of world earnings have been keeping pace with the US for some time now - both are up 20%+ in the past six months ([Figure 4](#)).<sup>1</sup> There's also the point that global investors bought [record amounts](#) of US equities in 2025, and may want to lighten up. The TIC data indicate this has happened a bit in 2026 ([Figure 5](#)).
- **Not in the top-tier.** Despite the recent Fed repricing, the US remains outside of the top-3 for yields - a spot it lost a year ago ([Figure 6](#)). And the price action may signal something - this front-end sell-off hasn't really moved the dollar, but instead just seen the two 'reconnect' ([Figure 7](#)).

Given the cross-currents, we shifted neutral on the dollar in [Blueprint](#). The oil story and potential for more Fed repricing pose upside risks. But an Iran war resolution would work the other way. While we wait, we like **selling EUR/JPY** amongst the larger currencies. Japan's data is outperforming the eurozone, yet rates repricing has gone the other way ([Figure 8](#)). And the [BoJ](#) sounds [more hawkish lately](#).

<sup>1</sup> Albeit it's not that broadly based - skewed to markets with AI and commodity leverage

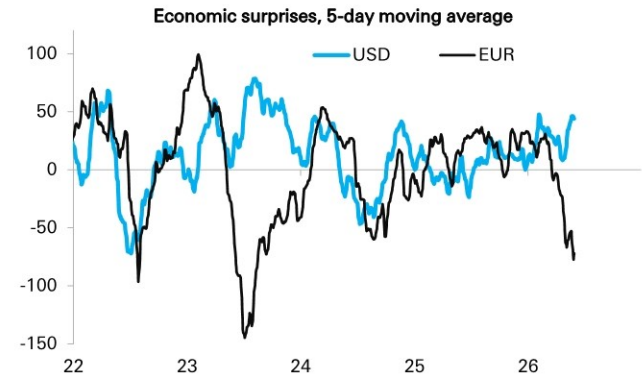


Figure 1: The US has returned to being a high growth country within G10



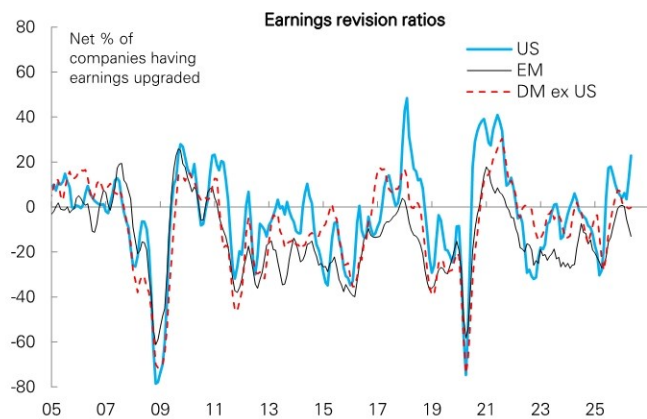
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 2: The US data is strong, but eurozone data has surprised to the downside



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 3: US corporate earnings are being upgraded, unlike others



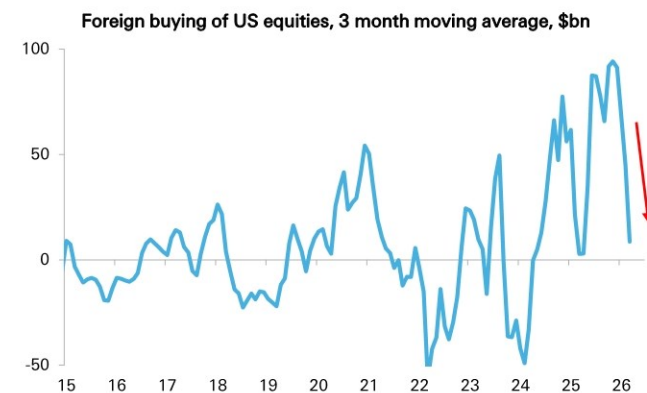
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Figure 4: US earnings are very strong, but so are RoW earnings



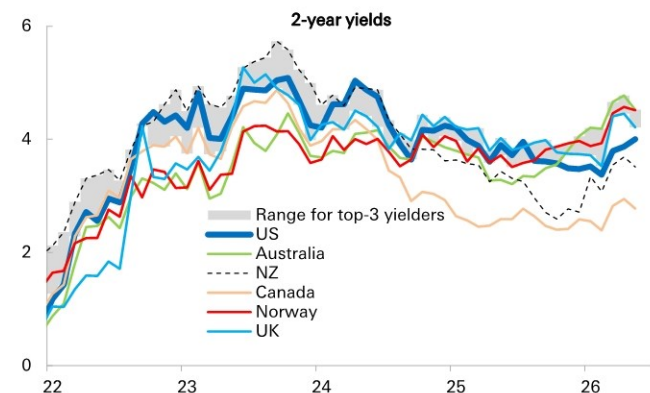
Source : Refinitiv Workspace Datastream, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 5: Foreign buying of US equities has slowed a lot in 2026, after record buying last year



Source : Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Research

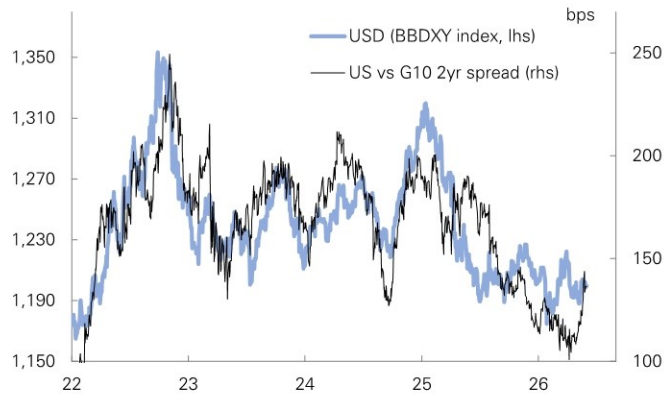
Figure 6: The US2y has risen a lot recently, but is still below the top-3 yielders



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research

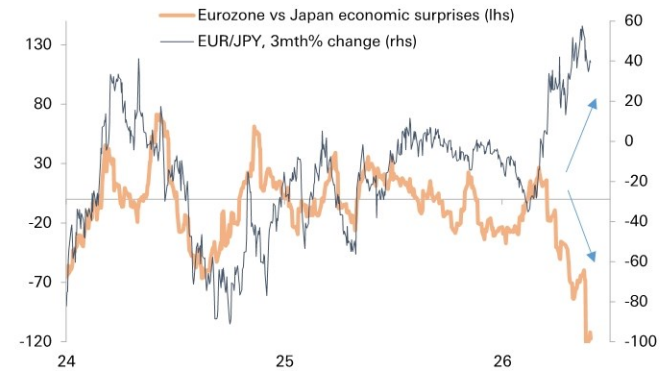


Figure 7: There's been a big front-end repricing for the US vs peers, but the USD is unmoved



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 8: The ECB has been repriced hawkishly vs the BoJ, despite the data going the other way



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research



# Appendix 1

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